

CURRENT AFFAIRS



**S & T HEALTH
ENVIRONMENT**



WHY & HOW

15th – 16th WEEK

MODULE - 2

INDIA AND WORLD

1 **'MOSQUIRIX': World's First Malaria Vaccine**

2 **Genome Sequencing to Map Population Diversity in India**

3 **NASA Spots 1st Molecule of the Universe**

4 **Factual Report on Great Indian Bustard**

5 **Mount Agung Volcano Eruption**

6 **Seychelles President's Underwater Speech**

7 **CMC of NGT to Prepare National Plan for Polluted Rivers**

8 **National Innovations in Climate Resilient Agriculture (NICRA)**

‘MOSQUIRIX’: World’s First Malaria Vaccine

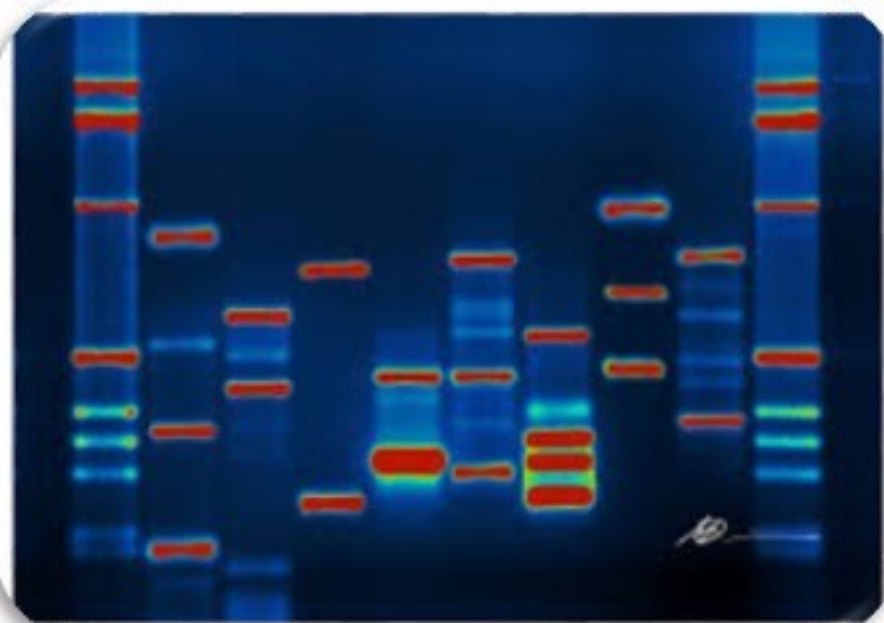


SALIENT POINTS

- African Nation, Malawi will be undertaking large scale pilot tests for the world’s most advanced experimental malaria vaccine – RTS,S or Mosquirix.
- The vaccine has been recommended by WHO for pilot introduction in 3 African countries- Ghana, Kenya and Malawi.

*Caused by the infectious Plasmodium
Spread: Female Anopheles mosquitoes
Leading cause of human morbidity and
mortality*

Genome Sequencing to Map Population Diversity in India First Time



*Human Genome Project -
was first sequenced in 2003*

SALIENT POINTS

- Earth BioGenome Project – successor
- Difference between genome and kinome
- CSIR project on nearly 1,000 rural youth from the length and breadth of India
- Genome sequencing of a sample of citizens may determine unique genetic traits, susceptibility (and resilience) to disease.
- This is the first time that such a large sample of Indians will be recruited for a detailed study.

*kinome of an organism is the complete set of
protein kinases encoded in its genome.*

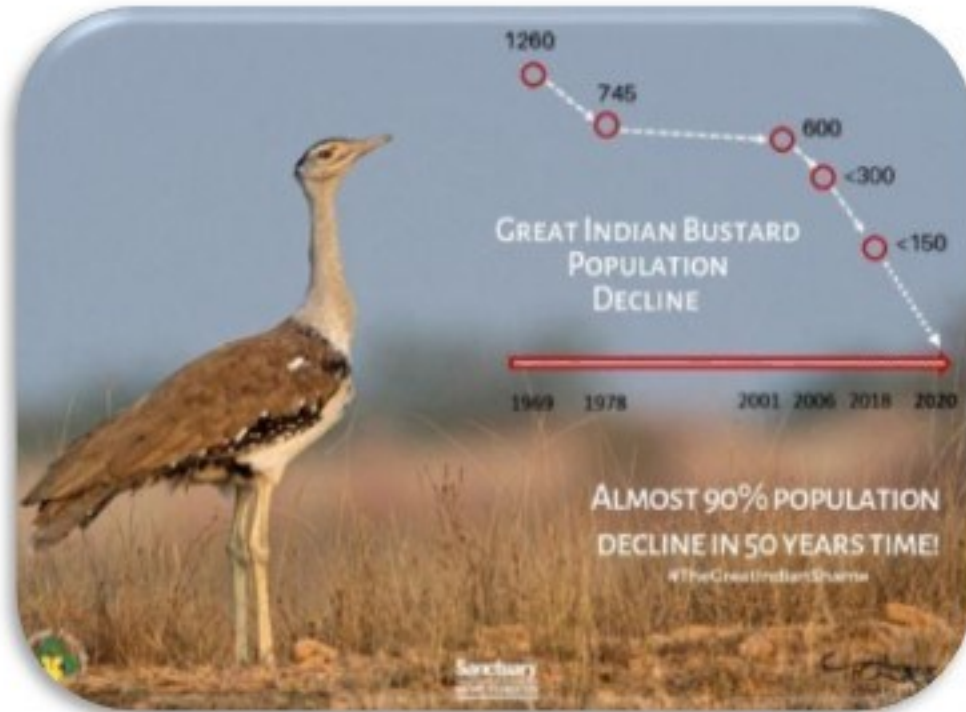
NASA Spots 1st Molecule of the Universe



SALIENT POINTS

- (NASA's) SOFIA- Stratospheric Observatory for Infrared Astronomy is the world's largest airborne observatory
- It detected 'helium hydride' in NGC 7027- a planetary nebula
- After the big bang, helium and hydrogen combined to make a molecule called helium hydride for the first time.

Factual Report on Great Indian Bustard by Rajasthan Forest Department



SALIENT POINTS

- The wind power projects and transmission lines were proving to be a major hazard for the survival of the endangered species in the desert area.
- Due to their weight, GIBs cannot fly at a high altitude. As a result, they caught in power lines
- GIB are critically endangered species who can be saved via installing 'bird diverters' on these power lines
- Underground transmission lines are necessary in their natural habitats

Mount Agung Volcano Eruption



SALIENT POINTS

- Mount Agung is an active volcano in Bali of Indonesia.
- The active volcano dominates the surrounding area, influencing the climate, especially rainfall patterns.
- The most important temple on Bali, Pura Besakih, is located high on the slopes of Mount Agung
- Along with it, two other volcanos Mount Bromo in East Java and Mount Merapi in Central Java and Indonesia also continues to erupt



MYANMAR
(BURMA)

Lao PDR

THAILAND

CAMBODIA

Gulf of
Thailand

South China Sea

Philippine Sea

North Pacific Ocean

Papua New
Guinea

Solomon

Coral Sea

Timor Sea

AUSTRALIA

INDONESIA

MOUNT AGUNG

BALI

Indian Ocean

Bay of Bengal

Seychelles President's Underwater Speech



SALIENT POINTS

- Seychelles President made a global plea for stronger protection of the Oceans which are beating blue heart of our planet
- Many island nations threatened by global warming.
- Seychelles is an archipelago of 115 islands in the Indian Ocean, off East Africa
- The speech was made during British-led science expedition, 'Nekton Mission' exploring the Indian Ocean depths.
- Nekton Mission in the Indian Ocean named First Descent to protect the Least protected ocean – The Indian Ocean



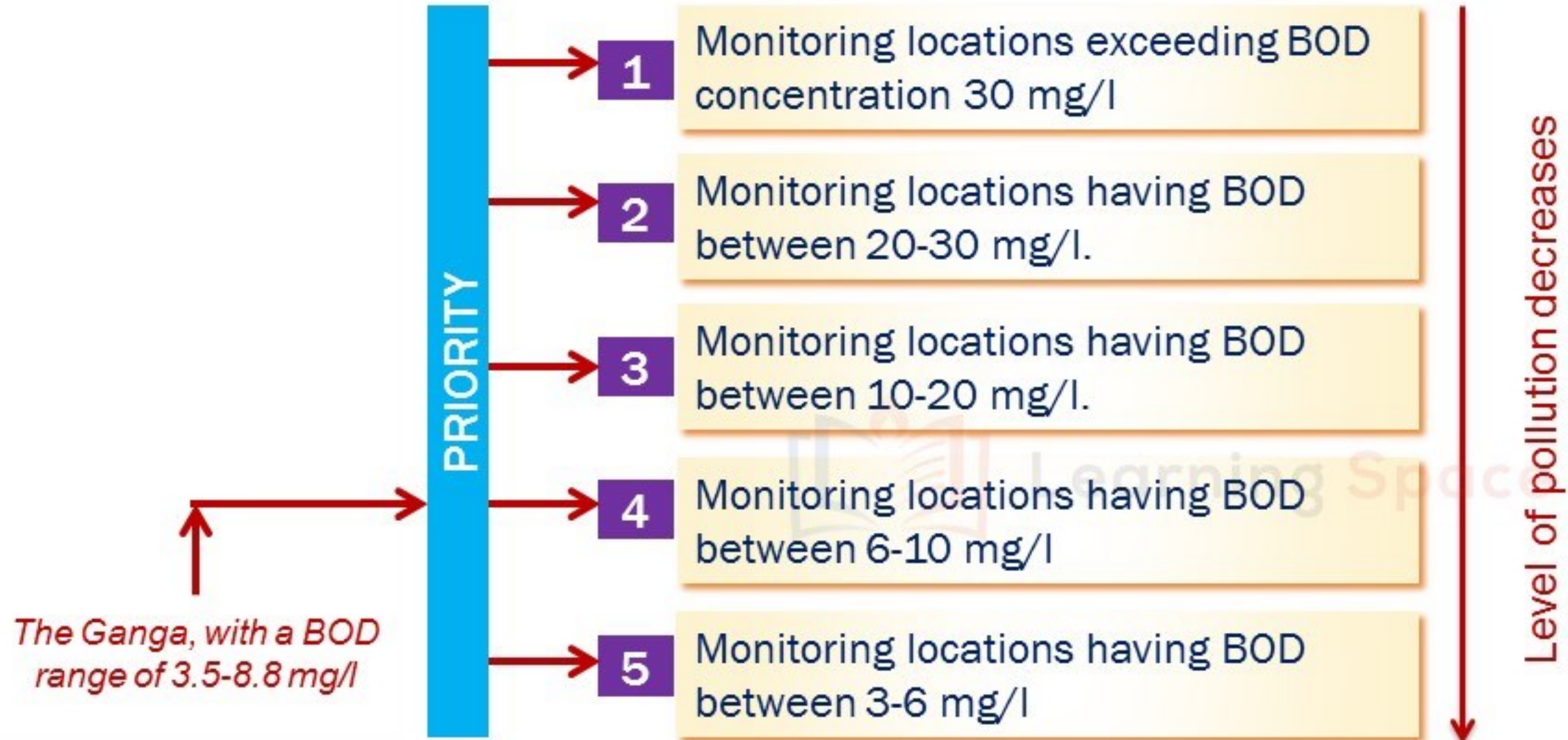
Central Monitoring Committee of NGT to Prepare National Plan for Polluted Rivers



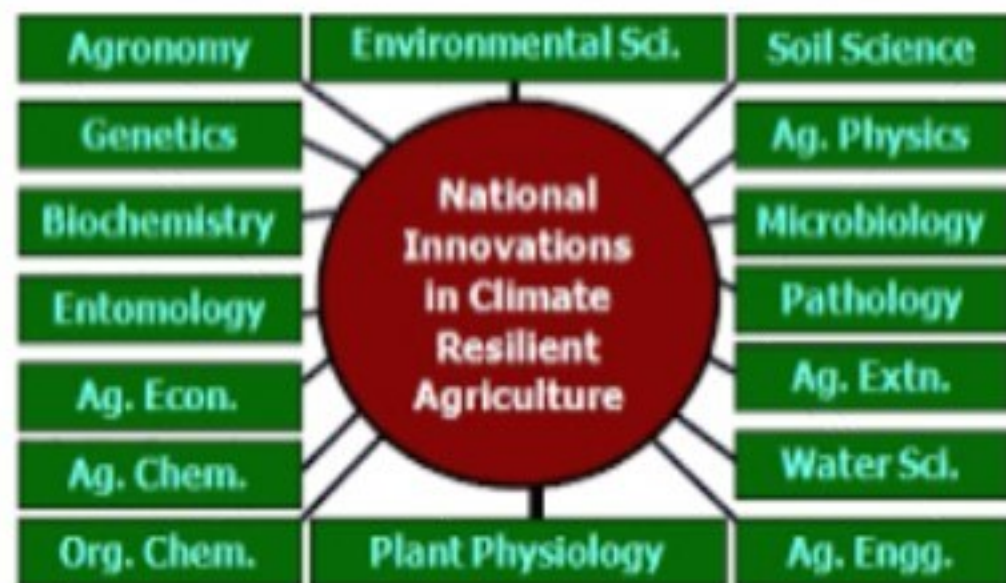
SALIENT POINTS

- The national plan is to make over 350 river stretches across the country pollution free
- The Central Monitoring Committee will also co-ordinate with the River Rejuvenation Committees of the states
- According to CPCB – Many river stretches are now critically polluted
- The CPCB considers a BOD less than 3 mg/l an indicator of a healthy river.
- Mithi river — from Powai to Dharavi — with a BOD of 250 mg/l is the most polluted river stretch.

IDENTIFICATION OF POLLUTED RIVER SOURCES - CPCB



National Innovations in Climate Resilient Agriculture (NICRA)



SALIENT POINTS

- NICRA is under Ministry of Agriculture & Farmers Welfare
- Launched by Indian Council of Agricultural Research to strengthen farmers by use of climate resilient agricultural technologies
- Other adaptation schemes and plans-
 - ✓ The National Mission for Sustainable Agriculture (NMSA),
 - ✓ The National Adaptation Fund,
 - ✓ The State Action Plan on Climate Change (SAPCC).

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